Edidiong Samuel

Developer Relations Engineer · Community Builder · Full-Stack Engineer

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SUMMARY

Developer Relations Engineer and full-stack engineer with 4+ years building production software and 2 years leading one of Nigeria's most active campus developer communities. Took GDGOC University of Uyo from a dormant ~500-member chapter to 900+ members, created three recurring programs, and is producing a two-day flagship event with a 1,000-capacity venue, nine partners and a ₦1M+ hackathon. Comfortable in the code and on the stage: Laravel, NestJS, React and TypeScript by day; community strategy, partnerships, content and developer education by calling.

CORE SKILLS

Community & DevRel: community strategy, program design, event production, sponsorship & partnerships, developer education, public speaking, technical writing, content & copy, API adoption, volunteer management

Engineering: Laravel, PHP, NestJS, Node.js, TypeScript, React, Vue.js, Next.js, REST APIs, webhooks, queues & workers, JWT / OAuth2

Data & infrastructure: MySQL, PostgreSQL, Redis, Docker, GitHub Actions, AWS, DigitalOcean, Laravel Cloud, cPanel / WHM, SSL & SMTP

Web3 & AI: Solidity, Foundry, Web3.js, Ethers.js, The Graph, Chainlink, Soroban (Stellar), n8n, OpenAI, Anthropic and Gemini APIs

COMMUNITY & DEVELOPER RELATIONS EXPERIENCE

Lead, Google Developer Groups on Campus (GDGOC)

2024 – Present

University of Uyo · Uyo, Nigeria · gdg.community.dev

- Rebuilt a dormant chapter of about 500 members into a 900+ member community by anchoring every activity to one flagship event, Tech Ignite, instead of general posting.
- Created and ran the Tech Career Series — three virtual sessions with eight senior speakers from Google, Paystack, Moniepoint, Raenest and Jobberman — owning speaker outreach, session scripts, interview questions, flyer copy and promotion.
- Created the Founders Pitch Series — four sessions featuring twelve early-stage founders — with an application form, scoring criteria and a pathway to the Tech Ignite stage.
- Leading production of Tech Ignite 2026: a two-day event at the University of Uyo with a 1,000-capacity main venue, a two-week hackathon, a ₦1M+ prize pool and nine confirmed partners, including Chowdeck, Paga, Google and Jobberman.
- Secured partners and built the sponsorship system: tiers, deck content, outreach emails and DMs, follow-up sequences, negotiation replies, invoices and partner bios; managed a target list of 30+ companies.
- Built the operating system for the event: a nine-tab command center, event brief, budget, preparation timeline, volunteer guild structure, design briefs, website copy, newsletter and announcement posts.
- Made Paga Engine and Africa's Talking APIs the core of the hackathon build, designing problem areas across transport, agriculture, education, healthcare and civic infrastructure, plus scoring and demo criteria.
- Ran a free beginner coding workshop with PY50, produced the She Builds women-in-tech event at Start Innovation Hub, and represented the chapter as a community partner and speaker at an AWS community event.

Community strategy · Event production · Partnerships · Content · Public speaking · API adoption

Managing Director & Head, Training and Curriculum Development

2026 – Present

Affidex Academy Limited · Uyo, Nigeria

- Oversee academic operations and curriculum at a federally registered vocational and digital skills institution.
- Drive campus outreach and institutional partnerships, and design training programs for developers and career switchers.

Curriculum design · Academic operations · Partnerships · Developer education

SELECTED PROGRAMS

TECH IGNITE 2026 — two-day flagship, 19–20 November 2026, University of Uyo. Theme: "Beyond the Hype: Are You Actually Building?" 1,000-capacity venue, two-week hackathon, ₦1M+ prize pool, nine partners. techignite.net

TECH CAREER SERIES — three sessions, eight senior speakers, May–August 2026. Speaker outreach, scripts, interview questions, flyers and promotion.

FOUNDERS PITCH SERIES — four sessions, twelve founders, August–September 2026. Application form, scoring criteria and a route to the Tech Ignite stage.

INTRO TO TECH WORKSHOP — free hands-on coding session for complete beginners, run with PY50 at Square One, Nwaniba, July 2026.

SHE BUILDS — women-in-tech event for International Women's Day at Start Innovation Hub, Uyo, including partnership proposals, social content and venue logistics.

AWS COMMUNITY EVENT — represented the chapter as a community partner and delivered a speaking slot on the community's work and roadmap.

ENGINEERING EXPERIENCE

Freelance Full-Stack Developer Jan 2026 – Present
Independent · Remote

- Designed and shipped a multi-currency e-commerce platform end to end — React storefront, React admin panel and Laravel REST API — supporting eight currencies through the Kora payment gateway.
- Delivered production deployment on constrained shared hosting (SSL, SMTP, MySQL compatibility, SPA routing) and GitHub Actions pipelines for zero-touch cPanel releases.

Laravel · React · MySQL · Kora · GitHub Actions · cPanel

Backend Engineer (Laravel API) Sep 2025 – Dec 2025
ShopittPlus · Uyo, Nigeria shopittplus.com

- Architected and scaled the core API for a multi-vendor marketplace: vendor onboarding, inventory, order lifecycle, delivery tracking and peer-to-peer transactions.
- Engineered Paystack payment and payout workflows, and cut response times through MySQL indexing, Redis caching and an event-driven order pipeline.

Laravel · MySQL · Redis · Paystack · n8n · GitHub Actions

Backend & Blockchain Engineer (NestJS) Mar 2025 – Nov 2025
Espay · Lagos, Nigeria

- Sole engineer on a peer-to-peer crypto exchange for Espees on the Toronet blockchain — architecture, backend, blockchain integration, database design and production troubleshooting.
- Built the NestJS service that syncs on-chain events with the application backend, with confirmation-delay handling and idempotency guards against duplicate settlement.

NestJS · TypeScript · Node.js · React · PostgreSQL · Toronet · Webhooks

Backend Engineer (Laravel API) Apr 2025 – Sep 2025
TransactX · Lagos, Nigeria mytransactx.com

- Built and scaled the core banking API behind TransactX, serving 50,000+ users at 99.9% reliability, with PSD2-compliant bank integrations, fraud detection and settlement reconciliation.
- Reduced API response times by 40% and sustained 15,000+ daily transactions through Redis caching and MySQL indexing.

Laravel · MySQL · Redis · JWT / OAuth2 · n8n · Laravel Cloud · GitHub Actions

Senior Full-Stack Developer Jan 2025 – Mar 2025
Tekinni · Remote tekinni.com

- Architected the Laravel eCommerce backend and built the Vue.js / TypeScript / Inertia.js frontend, contributing to a 30% increase in mobile conversions.
- Cut deployment downtime by 50% with GitHub Actions CI/CD.

Laravel · MySQL · Vue.js · Inertia.js · TypeScript · Tailwind · GitHub Actions

EARLIER EXPERIENCE

Backend Engineer (NestJS) — Kachim Oct 2024 – Dec 2024
Lagos, Nigeria · Contract
Built the backend for an EdTech platform: authentication, OTP verification, account lifecycle and four subscription tiers with Flutterwave payments.

Blockchain Engineer — VestPad Aug 2024 – Dec 2024
Remote · Contract vestpad.io
Designed a decentralized launchpad in Solidity and built The Graph subgraphs plus a Node.js / Web3.js pipeline for on-chain data.

Software Engineer — Swap2Naira Jun 2024 – Aug 2024
London, UK · Contract swap2naira.com
Architected the Laravel backend for a naira/crypto swap platform handling 20,000 daily transactions, and built the React/TypeScript frontend.

Software Engineer — Foodpreneurshub Aug 2024 – Oct 2024
Ontario, Canada · Contract
Refactored a production Laravel backend and introduced GitHub Actions deployments to cPanel, cutting release time by 40%.

Software Engineer — Fabricspa Oct 2022 – Dec 2022
Lagos, Nigeria · Contract
Built a laundry management platform from scratch in Laravel and Vue.js with real-time tracking and automated invoicing.

Backend (PHP) Tutor — The Roothub May 2023 – Aug 2023
Akwa Ibom, Nigeria
Taught PHP, API development and MySQL to cohorts of new developers; designed hands-on CRUD and API projects.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

BSc Computer Science — University of Uyo, Nigeria *(in progress)*

Certifications: Alchemy University — Blockchain Development · Cyfrin Updraft — Smart Contract Security · Postman — API Student Expert · IBM SkillsBuild — AI Fundamentals & AI Literacy